

Competitor conquering

A switching-focused Search build for Android comparison demand

PORTFOLIO EXERCISE - NOT CLIENT WORK

QUESTION

How can competitor demand be addressed without relying on unsupported product-comparison claims?

DECISION

Lead with switching friction, route to a purpose-built page, and isolate competitor terms and exclusions.

EVIDENCE RETAINED

Setup logic, landing-page requirements, keyword groups, ad messaging, and negative controls.

VALIDATION

Monitor search terms, policy compliance, assisted conversions, CPA, and post-click switching behavior.

SECTION 1

Campaign Setup & Bidding Strategy

Setting up a dedicated conquesting campaign built to intercept Samsung and Pixel shoppers before they finalize a purchase, rather than folding this into an existing iPhone campaign.

Locking the URL only matters if the page itself actually removes the objections the ad copy raises. For /iphone/switch/ specifically, that means a trade-in value calculator, a step-by-step Move to iOS walkthrough, testimonials from real Android switchers, an FAQ covering carrier compatibility, and financing options front and center, not buried below a generic hero banner. Those are the elements that turn a click into a completed switch rather than a bounce.

SECTION 4

Verified Sitelink Assets

Building four sitelinks that each answer a different objection a switcher might have.

Add details to match your ads to the right searches

Keywords

Get keyword suggestions (optional)

Google Ads can find keywords for you by scanning a web page or seeing what's working for similar products or services

Final URL





[Update keyword suggestions](#)

Enter keywords

Keywords are words or phrases that are used to match your ads with the terms people are searching for ?

"Samsung Galaxy S26"

[Samsung S26 Ultra]

"Google Pixel"

[Google Pixel Pro]

"best android phone"

"switch from android to iphone"

 **Upgrade your keywords to broad match:** Expand the reach of your campaign and get more conversions at a similar or better ROI ?

+0.1% Apply all

 **Add more keywords:** Show your ads more often to people searching for what your business offers ?

+4.3% View Apply all

Ad group settings for AI Max BETA Turned off for your ad group

Fig. 4: Keyword input screen showing the exact and phrase match terms built around flagship competitor models and explicit switching intent.

BEHIND THE STRATEGY

I paired phrase match on flagship model names, like “Samsung Galaxy S26” and “Google Pixel,” with exact match on the more specific configurations, like [Samsung S26 Ultra] and [Google Pixel Pro], and added direct switching phrases like “switch from android to iphone” and “best android phone.” Broad match stayed off the list entirely, since it would have pulled in general tech news searches or software troubleshooting queries that have nothing to do with a purchase decision, which is exactly the kind of traffic a conquering budget can't afford to chase.

Case Study 04: Competitor Conquesting Campaign

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The screenshot displays the Google Ads ad build interface. On the left, the 'Final URL' is set to <https://www.apple.com/iphone/>. The 'Display path' is [www.apple.com](#) / [Switch-To-iOS](#) / [iPhone](#). A chat bubble prompts for personalized help. The 'Headlines' section shows a list of suggestions: 'switch from android to iphone', 'best android phone', 'Google Pixel Pro', and 'Google Pixel'. Below this, a list of headlines is shown with their character counts: 'Thinking of Switching?' (22/30), 'Switch to iPhone® Easily' (24/30), 'Move to iOS in 1 Easy Step' (26/30), 'Transfer Apps & Photos Safely' (29/30), 'Official Apple® Switch Guide' (28/30), 'Trade In Your Android Phone' (27/30), 'Fast, Secure, and Simple' (24/30), 'Why Millions Make the Switch' (28/30), 'Get Credit Toward iPhone' (24/30), 'Seamless Android Transfer' (25/30), and three empty headline slots (0/30). On the right, the 'Preview' section shows a mobile device mockup with a Google search bar and results for the query 'switch from android to iphone'. A disclaimer at the bottom of the preview states: 'Previews shown here are examples and don't include all possible formats. You're responsible for the content of your ads. Please make sure that your provided assets don't violate any Google policies or applicable laws, either individually, or in combination.'

Fig. 5: Ad build screen showing the headline set and live SERP preview for the 'switch from android to iphone' query.

BEHIND THE STRATEGY

The screenshot shows the Google Ads interface for a campaign named 'Campaign 1'. The 'Negative Keywords' tab is selected, displaying a list of negative keywords. The table has four columns: 'Negative Keyword', 'Status', 'Match Type', and 'Score'. The list includes various terms such as 'screen replacement', 'factory reset', 'software update', 'used', 'refurbished', 'ebay', 'case', 'customer service', 'manual', 'forum', and 'teardown'. The status for all keywords is 'Enabled', and the match type is 'Exact'. The score for all keywords is 'Low'.

Negative Keyword	Status	Match Type	Score
screen replacement	Enabled	Exact	Low
factory reset	Enabled	Exact	Low
software update	Enabled	Exact	Low
used	Enabled	Exact	Low
refurbished	Enabled	Exact	Low
ebay	Enabled	Exact	Low
case	Enabled	Exact	Low
customer service	Enabled	Exact	Low
manual	Enabled	Exact	Low
forum	Enabled	Exact	Low
teardown	Enabled	Exact	Low

Fig. 6: Negative Keywords tab showing the campaign-level list built to block support, secondary-market, and informational searches from existing rival owners.

BEHIND THE STRATEGY

I split the negatives into three groups: support and repair terms like “screen replacement,” “factory reset,” and “software update,” since someone searching those already owns the device and isn't a switching prospect; secondary market and accessory terms like “used,” “refurbished,” “ebay,” and “case,” since that traffic is shopping for parts or a cheaper unit, not a new ecosystem; and informational support terms like “customer service,” “manual,” “forum,” and “teardown,” since those are existing owners looking for help, not people considering a change. All three groups share the same underlying signal: the searcher is already committed to their current device, which makes them the opposite of who this campaign is built to reach.

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